Laavin InfraScapes
Crafting Nature's Symphony

LIS

How to use the app

A simple guide for everyone at Laavin InfraScapes. No special knowledge needed.

Laavin Internal System, version 2.1.4

For supervisors, the office team and the owners

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Tip: you do not need to read all of it. Go to the chapter for your job: supervisors read chapters 2, 3 and 4; the office reads 2, 3 and 5 to 13.

1. What LIS is

LIS keeps all of Laavin's money work in one place, so nobody has to chase papers, messages or spreadsheets.

What it does for you

- Supervisors send in site expenses, ask for advance money, mark who came to work and see what they sent in.
- The office approves those claims, records bills from suppliers, raises invoices to clients and notes down every payment in and out.
- The owners see how much is due, how much cash there is, whether a project is making money, and the profit for the year.
- Every rupee entered once appears everywhere it should. You never type the same thing twice.

Who can see what

Your role	What you can do
Supervisor	Only their own work: their claims, their team, their projects, their attendance and the advance money given to them. They cannot see invoices, bank balances, salaries of others or company accounts.
CXO	Everything about the business: invoices, bills, reports, approvals, HR. In Settings, only the general settings (not users, bank accounts or closing the year).
Admin	Everything the CXO sees, plus adding or removing users, bank accounts and other settings, and closing the year.

> **GOOD TO KNOW**
> If a page or button described in this guide is missing for you, that is normal. It means your role is not meant to use it.

2. Signing in and staying safe

Signing in

1. Open the LIS link on your phone or computer.
2. Type your phone number (or email) and your 6-digit PIN.
3. Press Sign in. Supervisors are asked to allow location the first time. Please say Allow, because the app will not open without it.

Your PIN

- Everyone signs in with a 6-digit PIN. Keep it to yourself.
- Forgot your PIN? Ask the Admin to set a new one. Nobody else can do it.

Staying signed in

The app keeps you signed in, even after you close it, until you press Sign out yourself.

> **ALWAYS SIGN OUT ON SHARED DEVICES**
> Use the arrow-out icon at the top right of the screen when you finish, especially on a computer or phone that other people use.

3. Finding your way around

On a computer, the menu is on the left. On a phone, press the small Laavin logo at the top left to open it. The most-used pages also sit in a bar at the bottom of the phone screen.

The menu for the office team

The pages are grouped by the job they do:

Overview	Dashboard (the big picture) and Approvals (things waiting for you).
Sales	Invoices: bills you send to clients, and the money they pay.
Purchases	Procurements (bills from suppliers) and Vendor (what you owe each supplier).
Money	Expenses, Transfers between accounts, Loans and Capital put in by the partners.
People and projects	Projects, HR (attendance, salary, advances), Calendar and Supervisor entry.
Books	Reports (including profit and loss) and Settings.

Three shortcuts worth learning

- Search: press Ctrl and K together (or the / key), or press the Search button at the top. Type any part of a client, invoice number, supplier, project or staff name, then press Enter. It takes you straight there.
- The bell: shows how many claims are waiting for approval. Press it to go to Approvals.
- Split view (large screens): shows two pages side by side, for example the Dashboard next to Invoices.

Messages you will see

- A small box at the bottom of the screen saying "Saved" means it worked. A red one tells you what went wrong and what to fix.
- Before anything is deleted, a box asks you to confirm. Read it, then press Cancel or the red button.
- If a page ever shows "This page hit a problem", press Reload. Your saved work is safe.

> **INSTALL IT LIKE AN APP**
> On a phone, open the menu and press Install app (or use your browser's "Add to home screen"). It then opens like any other app.

4. For supervisors at the site

This chapter is for field supervisors. Your menu is short on purpose: Dashboard, Claims and Advances, Calendar and Records.

Your Dashboard: your team for the day

1. Choose the date at the top (it opens on today).
2. Your team is listed. For each person, mark whether they came, and which project they worked on.
3. If someone is on leave, mark the leave. You can see the leave dates for any person.
4. Anything wrongly marked can be changed until the office approves that day.

Sending an expense claim

1. Open Claims and Advances.
2. Choose the project and what the money was spent on.
3. Type the amount, the date and a short note. Add a photo of the bill if you have one.
4. Press Save. The claim goes to the office as "pending". It becomes a real expense only after the office approves it.

Asking for advance money

Open "Request Advance", type how much you need and why, and send. The office sees it and releases the money. The advance you hold is called your imprest: money given to you for site spending. Your spending is set against it.

Other claims

Use "Other Claims" for things that are not a normal project expense. The office will review them in the same way.

Records

Records shows everything you have sent: which claims were approved, which are still waiting, which were rejected, and the advances you were given.

Calendar

The Calendar shows your team's attendance and leave, and the company holidays, month by month.

Hindi

Press the small button at the top (it shows a Hindi letter, or EN) to switch the whole app between Hindi and English.

IF YOUR CLAIM WAS REJECTED

Open Records, look at the claim, and read the comment from the office. Fix what they asked for, or send it again as a new claim.

5. Approvals and expenses

For the office team.

Approving supervisors' claims

1. Press the bell, or choose Approvals from the menu.
2. You see each supervisor's waiting claims. Open one to see the amount, project, note and bill photo.
3. Press Approve, or Reject and give a short reason so the supervisor knows what to fix.

An approved claim is entered in the books straight away. A rejected one is not.

> **WHY THIS MATTERS**
> Supervisors cannot approve their own claims. The system does not allow it, even if they try.

Adding an expense yourself

1. Open Expenses. Choose the group at the top: Admin (office costs), Trips, or Project (site costs).
2. Fill in the details: the project, the head and sub-head the money belongs to, quantity, rate, date and amount.
3. If the bill has GST, say whether the amount you typed includes GST or not, and give the GST rate.
4. Choose how it was paid: from a bank account, in cash, or from the supervisor's advance (imprest).
5. Press Save.

> **TRIPS: WHAT WAS SPENT, AND FROM WHERE**
> Under Trips, above every list of trip entries, a line shows the total split by how it was paid: Kotak, Cash, CBI and Reimbursement (someone paid from their own pocket and is owed back). It is shown for the open trip, for each trip in Trip records, for all the trips in the period you have chosen, and in the Trips report. The same split goes into the PDF and Excel downloads.

> **THE CALCULATOR WORKS FROM THE KEYBOARD**
> Beside the Amount box is a calculator. Press its button, then type the sum with the keyboard: + - * / and brackets. Enter gives the result and puts it in the Amount box. Esc closes it. The buttons on the screen work too.

Phoning it in for a supervisor

Open "Supervisor" in the menu to fill in the same form a supervisor uses, under their name, when they have sent the details by phone.

Fixing a mistake

Find the entry in the list, open its menu, and edit or delete it. Deleting asks you to confirm. Every change is recorded: who did it, when, and what it looked like before.

6. Buying: supplier bills and payments

Recording a supplier bill

1. Open Procurements.
2. Choose the project, the supplier and the type of cost.
3. Type the bill date, the supplier's own invoice number and date, the bill value and the GST rate.
4. If you are holding back tax (TDS) from this supplier, tick "TDS deducted" and choose the rate. The app works out how much to hold back and how much to pay.
5. Press Save.

> **WHAT WAS BOUGHT ON A BILL**
> Under the bill description, press "Add the items bought on this bill". For each item type the name, the quantity, the unit and the rate. The amount is worked out for you, or you can type it if there is no rate. When a bill has items, the bill value is the total of the items, and you cannot type over it. GST and TDS are still set once for the whole bill. In Bill records, a bill with items shows "N items" under its description: press it to see them. The items are also in the Excel and PDF downloads. The same items table is in Record this, when you make a vendor bill from a bank payment.

> **SAME BILL TWICE**
> The app refuses to save two bills with the same invoice number for one supplier. This stops double entry by mistake.

Paying a supplier

On the bill, record the payment: the date, the amount and which account it came from. You can pay a bill in parts. The bill shows what is still due.

Paying a supplier before there is a bill (an advance)

Sometimes you pay a supplier first and the bill comes later. Do not make up a bill for it. Record an advance instead.

1. Open Procurements and press "Advances to vendors" to open it.
2. Choose the supplier, the amount, the date and the account you paid from. Add a reference if you have one, such as the bank transfer number.
3. Press "Record advance".

You can also do this from the bank statement: press "Record this" on the payment and choose "Advance to a vendor (no bill yet)".

THE BILL TAKES THE ADVANCE BY ITSELF

When you later record that supplier's bill, the app sets the oldest advance against it. You pay only what is left. If the advance is more than the bill, the rest waits for the next bill. Under "Advances to vendors" you can see, for every advance, how much has been used and how much is not yet used. An advance is not a cost. It becomes a cost when the bill is recorded.

Making the bill from a bank payment

If you paid a supplier from the bank and the bill is not in the app yet, you can make the bill and the payment together from the bank statement. This also works for a supplier who is not in the app yet.

1. Open Reports, then "Bank reconciliation", choose the account and upload the statement.
2. Press "Record this" beside the payment and choose "Vendor bill and payment (the bill is not entered yet)".
3. Pick the supplier, or press "Add a new vendor" to create one. Pick the project and the type of purchase, and write what was bought.
4. Choose the GST rate, and the TDS if you held any back. The app works out the bill value from the amount that left the bank, and shows what it comes to.
5. If the payment is only part of a bigger bill, tick that box and type the whole bill value. The rest stays due on the bill.
6. Press Save. The bill and the payment are both made, and the statement line matches by itself.

What you owe each supplier

Open Vendor. Pick a supplier to see all their bills, all your payments and the balance between them. You can download it as PDF or Excel to send to them.

7. Selling: invoices and payments

Raising an invoice

1. Open Invoices and start a new invoice.
2. Choose the client and the project.
3. Type the invoice number, date, the service description and its HSN or SAC code (the tax code for the work).
4. Type the amount before GST. Then the GST rate, the TDS rate (tax the client holds back) and the retention rate if there is one.
5. Choose Draft if you are not ready, or Sent when it goes to the client.
6. Press Save.

> **DRAFT OR SENT?**
> A Draft is only a note to yourself. It does not touch the books. Only invoices marked Sent are counted as sales, appear in the GST reports and show what clients owe you.

The invoice PDF

Every invoice can be downloaded as a neat PDF with the Laavin logo, address, GST number, the tax split, the amount in words and bank details. Fill in your company details once in Settings and it appears on every invoice.

Recording a payment from the client

1. Open the invoice (or the client's ledger) and choose to record a payment.
2. Type the date, the amount, which of your accounts it came into, and the reference.
3. Press Save. The amount due on the invoice goes down.

Colours help you read the list. A red amount is money still due. A green amount is money the client paid in extra. A highlighted row means a payment is due. If a client pays extra, the extra is carried forward and can be set against the next invoice.

Retention money

Some clients keep back a part of each bill (say 5 or 10 percent) until the work is fully done. This is called retention. You still own it, but it is not due yet. It is shown separately in blue, with a release date, so you know when to ask for it. When the client releases it, use "Release retention" and the amount moves out of the held amount.

Credit notes and debit notes

If an invoice must be reduced (a discount, a mistake) raise a credit note against it. If it must be increased, raise a debit note. The invoice's amount, GST and balance all update, and the note shows in the GST reports.

Clients who release GST only after proof

A few clients pay the GST part only after Laavin has filed its GST return and sent proof. In Settings, open that client and tick "Releases GST only after we file GSTR-3B and send proof". From then on:

- The GST part is shown as held, and is not counted as overdue.
- When you have filed, record the date filed, the return month and the date you sent the proof.
- When the client releases the GST, enter how much of the payment was GST. The held amount reduces.
- The "GST release statement" report shows, client by client, what is held and what is released.

Downloads

Each client's ledger can be downloaded as PDF or Excel, showing every invoice, payment, and the retention worked out on a separate sheet.

Adding many at once

If you have many old invoices and payments in Excel, use "Bulk-add invoices and receipts from Excel" at the top of the Invoices page.

8. Money in the bank, loans and capital

Transfers

Use Transfers when money only moves from one of your own places to another: cash to bank, one bank to another. Pick From, To, the amount and the date. It is not an expense and not income.

Loans

Record a loan you have taken: the type, who lent it, the amount, the interest rate and the date. Record each repayment against it. The report shows what is still owed.

Capital

Capital is money the partners put into the business, or take out. Record each amount: which partner, whether it came in or went out, how much, and the date.

> **IMPORTANT FOR THE BALANCE SHEET**
> If no capital is entered, the Balance Sheet shows the partners' money as profit. Enter the money each partner has put in (dated when it happened) and the sheet becomes correct.

Projects

Open Projects to see, for each project: the budget, what has been billed, what has been spent and what is left. Press a line to see the bills and expenses behind it.

9. People: attendance, salary and advances

HR has four parts. Choose them at the top of the page.

Attendance

See who worked, on which project, on any date. The office can approve the days a supervisor marked, and mark attendance for a supervisor who could not.

Salary

Wages are worked out from the days worked and each person's daily rate. Record each payment and any advance given to a worker. When you pay, you can take back part of an advance at the same time. The history shows every amount earned, paid and advanced.

Imprest (site advance money)

Imprest is the money given to a supervisor to spend on site. Here you give an advance, record money returned, and see requests waiting from supervisors. The balance shows how much each supervisor still holds.

Check-ins

Shows where and when each supervisor opened the app, so you know they are on site. Choose the supervisor and the dates to see the history.

10. Reports: seeing the whole picture

Open Reports. Use the search box at the top to find a report, press one to open it, choose the period, and download it as PDF or Excel.

The reports you will use most

Report	What it tells you
Profit and Loss	What you earned, what you spent and what is left, for a financial year (April to March), side by side with last year.
Balance Sheet	What the business owns and owes on one day, and the partners' share. It says clearly whether it balances.
Client report and ledger	How much each client owes, and every invoice and payment behind it.
Vendor report and ledger	How much you owe each supplier.
Cash and bank	How much money is in cash and in each bank account.
Project profitability	Money in against money out, project by project.
Expense breakdown	Where the money went, by type of cost.
GST and TDS register	Every invoice with its GST and the TDS the client held back.
GST return workings	The figures you need to file GST each month (see below).
Bank reconciliation	Checks your records against the bank statement (see below).
Books health check	A list of things in the books that look wrong or incomplete, such as a missing GST number.

Reading the Balance Sheet

It has two sides that must be equal: what the partners and others have put in or are owed, and what the business has. If they are not equal, a red message says by how much. This should never happen, and if it does, check the Books health check and tell the Admin.

Filing GST each month

1. Open "GST return workings" and choose the month.
2. Read the GSTR-3B box: tax on your sales, less tax you paid on purchases (input credit), gives the tax to pay.
3. Download the workings. They list your sales invoices to businesses (B2B), to the public (B2C), credit and debit notes and a summary by tax code.
4. Download your purchase list (GSTR-2B) from the GST website, and choose that file in the matching box on the same page. The app shows which supplier bills match, which differ, and which are missing.

WHY MATCH WITH GSTR-2B

You can claim tax paid on a purchase only if the supplier has also shown it on their return. Bills "in your books, not in 2B" are credit you cannot claim yet. Ask the supplier to file.

Matching the bank statement

This is how you check that your books agree with the bank. Do it once a month for each bank account.

1. Download the bank statement for the month from net banking, as Excel or CSV. A PDF cannot be read.
2. Open Reports, then "Bank reconciliation", and choose the bank account.
3. Under "Match with the bank statement", choose the file. The statement date and closing balance fill in by themselves.
4. The app matches each statement line to your books by amount and date. Look at the "Ready to tick" list, untick anything that looks wrong, and press "Tick selected".
5. Look at "On the statement, not in your books". This is usually bank charges, interest, or a payment you forgot to enter. Press "Record this" beside a line to enter it (see below).
6. Look at "In your books, not on the statement". This is usually a cheque that has not cleared yet. If it is old, check it. Press "Open this entry" to go to the screen where it was made.
7. When the message says "The books and the bank statement agree", press "Done: save this reconciliation" and confirm. The app records who did it, when, and the figures. If a difference is left, you must write what explains it before you can save.

Your ticks are saved as you make them, so you can stop and come back. "Done" is the final confirmation. Under it you see every saved reconciliation for that bank. If an entry dated inside a saved period is added, changed or deleted later, that line shows "Books changed since", which tells you to look at it again.

RECORD THIS, AND OPEN THIS ENTRY

Press "Record this" beside a statement line that is not in your books. A form opens with the date, amount, bank account and statement text already filled in. Choose what it was: a transfer between your accounts, an expense (bank charges, site costs), a trip expense (pick the trip and what it was spent on), a reimbursement to an employee (pick the person; the amount is split over what they are owed, oldest first), a payment to a vendor (pick the unpaid bill), a vendor bill and payment together when the bill is not entered yet, an advance to a vendor when there is no bill yet, a receipt from a client (pick the invoice, or give each invoice its part if one payment settled several), capital a partner put in or took out (pick the partner), a new loan received (type who gave it), or the repayment of a loan (pick the loan and say how much of the amount was interest). Press Save and the line matches by itself. Press "Open this entry" beside a line in your books to go to the screen where it was made, so you can change or delete it. Your uploaded statement is kept for the session, so you can go there and come back through Reports, then Bank reconciliation.

WHY AN ENTRY MAY NOT SHOW FOR THIS BANK

Each entry shows on the page of the bank account it was paid from. A trip cost paid from Kotak shows when you choose Kotak, not CBI. A cost marked "reimbursable" (someone paid it from their own pocket) is not in any bank yet. It is recorded as money owed to that person, and it reaches a bank only when you pay them back. The bank statement then shows one transfer to that person for the total.

ONE PAYMENT, SEVERAL ENTRIES (AND THE OTHER WAY ROUND)

Sometimes the bank shows one transfer where your books have several entries: a person repaid for many expenses in one transfer, or a client paying several invoices together. The app adds up the entries and matches them to the one statement line. It also works the other way: when the bank shows several payments that your books hold as a single entry, they are matched to it together. When all the lines are from one day, the match is shown as normal. When the app had to search for a combination that adds up, it is marked "check it", so look before you tick. Ticking a grouped match ticks every entry in it.

WHAT EACH ENTRY IN YOUR BOOKS IS

Under Your books, every entry shows its system label first (for example Vendor payment or Reimbursement paid) and then what was typed when it was made: the description, the vendor, the note or the reference. This is the line to read when you are deciding whether a statement line is that entry.

CHOOSING WHICH ENTRIES A REPAYMENT SETTLES

When you repay someone their reimbursement, the app settles their oldest unpaid entries first. If the payment was for particular entries, tick "Choose which entries this payment settles" (on the Settle box of the dashboard, or in Record this). Then type how much of the payment goes to each entry. The amounts must add up to what you paid, and no entry can be given more than is still due on it. Fill oldest first puts back the default.

IF A MATCH IS WRONG

Beside every matched line you will find two buttons. "Change" opens a list of the other entries in your books with the same amount: pick the one the statement line really is. "Unmatch" breaks the match, so the statement line goes under "not in your books" and can be recorded with "Record this", and the entry goes under "not on the statement". The two will not be matched together again. If the old match had already been ticked, the tick is taken off too, and the app asks you first. Matches that join several lines into one (a lump sum) can be unmatched but not changed. Matched lines that were ticked earlier are under "Already ticked" in the list view.

SEE BOTH SIDES AT ONCE

Press "Side by side" above the results. The bank statement is on the left and your books on the right. Matched lines share a green colour and a number, and the lines in question are red (only on one side) or amber (matched, but check). Click a line to see its partner on the other side. If two lines have the same amount and the app paired the wrong ones, click the right line and press "Pair with selected" on its partner.

IF A COLUMN WAS GUESSED WRONG

Open "Check which column is which" and pick the right column for Date, Money in and Money out. The matches update at once. You can also tick lines by hand in the list at the bottom of the page.

Closing the year

At the end of March, the Admin opens the Profit and Loss or Balance Sheet for that year and presses "Close the year". After this, nothing dated on or before 31 March can be added, changed or deleted. This protects the finished accounts. Before closing, check the Books health check and the Balance Sheet.

THINK BEFORE CLOSING

Closing can only be undone by the Admin in Settings (company details, "Books locked up to"). Close only when the year's numbers have been checked.

11. Settings: set it up once

Open Settings. Each heading opens when you press it.

Company details	Name, GST number, Udyam number, address, phone, email and bank details. These print on every invoice. Admin can also set the date up to which the books are closed.
Clients	Each client's name, GST number and address. The state in the GST number decides how GST is split on invoices. Tick the GST-on-proof box where it applies.
Vendors	Each supplier's name, GST number and PAN.
Projects	Name, client, budget, dates and site location.
Staff	Each worker's name, phone, daily rate and which supervisor they report to.
Users	People who can sign in. Add a name, phone, role and a 6-digit PIN. For supervisors, choose the projects they look after.
Bank accounts	Your bank accounts, used when you record payments.
Cost centers, Units, Chart of accounts, Holidays	Lists the app uses in its drop-downs. Change them only if you know why.

> **WHY GST NUMBERS MATTER**
> Clients and suppliers without a GST number cannot be placed in the right GST group, and the monthly return will show some tax as "not split". Fill them in once and it is done for good.

12. Routines

Every day

- Supervisors: mark attendance and send claims.
- Office: check the bell and approve or reject waiting claims.
- Record any payments received or made.

Every week

- Open the Dashboard. Look at "Needs attention": overdue invoices, claims waiting, advances outstanding.
- Follow up clients on overdue invoices.
- Pay suppliers whose bills are due.

Every month

1. Enter every bill and expense for the month.
2. Run the bank reconciliation for each account and clear any difference.
3. Open the Books health check and fix what it lists.
4. Run "GST return workings", match with GSTR-2B and file the return.
5. Check that TDS deducted by clients is matching Form 26AS on the tax website.
6. Pay salaries and record them in HR.

Every year (April)

1. Check the Balance Sheet balances and the Books health check is clean.
2. Enter any capital the partners put in or took out.
3. Admin presses "Close the year".
4. Download the Profit and Loss and Balance Sheet for your accountant.

13. If something goes wrong

What you see	What to do
"That invoice number is already used"	Another invoice has the same number. Check the invoice list and use the next free number.
"This vendor already has a bill with that number"	The bill is probably already entered. Search for it before adding again.
I cannot add or change an old entry	The books are closed up to a date. Ask the Admin. Only the Admin can move that date.
A page or button is missing	Your role is not meant to use it. Ask the Admin if you think you should.
The numbers look wrong	Open Reports, then Books health check. It lists what looks wrong. Then ask the Admin.
A red box with a message	Read it. It says what went wrong and what to change. Fix that and try again.

> **NOTHING IS EVER REALLY LOST**
> Every change to the important records is written in an audit trail (Reports, Audit log): who changed what, when, and what it was before. If you are unsure whether something was changed, look there.

14. Words explained

Word	What it means
GST	Goods and Services Tax. Charged on your invoices, collected for the government.
Input credit	GST you paid on your purchases. It can be set against the GST you collected.
TDS	Tax Deducted at Source. A part of your bill that the client keeps back and pays to the government for you. You get credit for it later.
Retention	A part of each bill the client holds back until the work is complete.
HSN / SAC	The tax code for goods (HSN) or services (SAC) printed on an invoice.
GSTR-1	The monthly list of your sales that you report on the GST website.
GSTR-3B	The monthly summary return in which you pay the GST.
GSTR-2B	A list the GST website gives you of the purchases your suppliers have reported.
Imprest	Money given to a supervisor to spend on site.
Ledger	The full list of entries for one person or account, with a running balance.
Reconciliation	Checking that two records agree, such as your books and the bank statement.
Capital	Money the partners put into the business.
Draft / Sent	Draft invoices are rough copies. Sent invoices are final and count in the books.
Books closed	A date up to which nothing can be changed any more.
Financial year	April 1 to March 31.